The Rich Report

U.S. Economics News:

- **Bond Yield Surge:** Global 10-year government bond yields rose across nearly all tracked countries in the 12 months ended March 30, 2026, with Japan (+82.8 bps), Australia (+61.0 bps), and Canada (+49.7 bps) leading gains; only China and Switzerland saw declines. Iran war-driven energy price shocks have reignited inflation fears, with seven of ten countries carrying year-end inflation forecasts above current headline readings.[3]
- **Manufacturing Expansion:** The ISM Manufacturing Index hit 52.7 in March, marking the first three-consecutive-month expansion since 2022, with order backlogs growing for a third straight month after contracting for 39 months. The critical caveat is the prices paid index surging to 78.3 from 59.0 just two months prior, reflecting intensifying input cost pressures tied to the Iran conflict and ongoing tariff uncertainty.[3]
- **Trade Deficit Narrows:** The U.S. goods and services trade deficit came in at $57.3 billion in February, below the $60.6 billion consensus, and is $62.5 billion smaller than a year ago — a dramatic shift driven by exports rising 12.2% and imports falling 7.1% year-over-year. China has fallen to fourth among U.S. import sources as exports to the U.S. dropped 45.4% in early 2026, displaced partly by Taiwan whose exports surged 97.7% on AI-driven semiconductor demand.[3]
- **Fed Balance Sheet:** The Federal Reserve posted $21 billion in operating losses in 2025, bringing its cumulative deferred asset — effectively accumulated losses — to $243 billion by year-end, a legacy of paying banks 3.65% on reserves while earning less from its Treasury and MBS portfolio. The Fed's unrealized portfolio losses stand at $844 billion, roughly 18 times its $46 billion in reported capital, though unlike commercial banks it faces no regulatory solvency trigger.[3]
- **Markets Rally:** The S&P 500 gained 3.38% for the week ended April 3, 2026, led by Communications Services (+6.41%) on SpaceX IPO optimism and broad risk-on sentiment, while Treasury yields fell sharply across maturities as Iran conflict uncertainty drove safe-haven demand. Energy was the week's worst sector, declining 5.34%, as markets priced in hopes of a faster conflict resolution, with crude oil futures nonetheless elevated at $111.54 per barrel.[3]

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security.

The Rich Report

Digital Assets News:

- **Q1 2026 Performance:** Bitcoin ended the first quarter of 2026 down 23.8%, marking its steepest quarterly decline in eight years and echoing the brutal drawdowns of the 2018 bear market. The drop erased gains from late 2025's rally, rattling institutional investors who had entered at cycle highs and reigniting debate over whether the four-year market cycle remains intact.[5]
- **Fear Extreme:** The Fear & Greed Index languished at 8 out of 100 — deep within "extreme fear" territory — for 46 consecutive days, a streak of sustained panic not recorded since the Terra-Luna collapse wiped out roughly $40 billion in May 2022. The prolonged reading signals not a brief sentiment dip, but entrenched investor pessimism driven by macro uncertainty, regulatory pressure, and persistent selling.[5]
- **Fed Divergence:** Since early 2024, Bitcoin's historically tight correlation with global central bank easing cycles has inverted sharply, with BTC increasingly *anticipating* rather than reacting to monetary policy shifts. Spot ETF inflows appear to be the structural catalyst — institutional capital now prices in rate trajectory expectations ahead of official Fed signals, decoupling Bitcoin from the traditional liquidity-driven asset playbook.[5]
- **CLARITY Act Roundtable:** The SEC has scheduled an April 16 roundtable to examine the CLARITY Act, legislation aimed at defining jurisdictional boundaries between the SEC and CFTC over digital assets. The discussion marks a significant procedural step toward resolving years of regulatory ambiguity that has hindered institutional crypto adoption, left projects in legal limbo, and prompted major exchanges to relocate operations offshore.[5]

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security.

The Rich Report

Geopolitics News:

- **Asia:** The Iran war's oil shock is hitting Asia hardest first, with factories cutting production and gas stations rationing fuel. Oxford Economics estimates global oil supply is 10% below pre-war levels, with Europe and Africa next in line to feel severe shortages as their Gulf shipments run out.[1]
- **China:** Beijing has resumed island-building in the South China Sea after nearly a decade, constructing what could be its largest military base at Antelope Reef in the Paracel Islands, including what appears to be a runway, missile facilities, and surveillance infrastructure.[1]
- **France/Japan:** French President Macron and Japanese PM Takaichi agreed to closely coordinate on ending the Iran war and reopening the Strait of Hormuz. Japan, which imports roughly 90% of its oil from the Middle East, is drawing on strategic reserves, and has signaled it could dispatch minesweepers within its pacifist constitutional constraints.[1]
- **Iran:** The Iranian parliament approved a toll system for Strait of Hormuz transits, requiring payment in yuan or crypto from approved nations while barring vessels linked to the U.S., Israel, and sanctioning countries. The IRGC is already extracting tolls and granting safe passage to friendly-nation ships, with traffic rising to its highest level since early March.[1]
- **Iran:** U.S. intelligence reports that Iran is rapidly repairing bombed missile bunkers, returning them to operation within hours of strikes, and retains a significant missile arsenal. Despite the Pentagon claiming 11,000 targets struck, American agencies are skeptical that Iran's missile capability has been substantially degraded.[1]
- **Iran:** The U.S. dropped bunker-buster bombs on a large ammunition depot in Isfahan and struck Iran's largest petrochemical complex at Asaluyeh, cutting electricity to the site. A U.S. airman was rescued after two days hiding in remote Iranian mountains following the shootdown of his F-15E.[1]
- **Lebanon:** More than 1.2 million Lebanese have been displaced since Israel launched its offensive on March 2 following Hezbollah's decision to support Iran. Over 1,200 have been killed, and Beirut is overwhelmed with displaced people sheltering in tents, cars, and mosques across the capital.[1]
- **UAE:** The UAE is preparing to join a coalition to forcibly reopen the Strait of Hormuz, lobbying for a UN Security Council resolution authorizing military action — which Bahrain is sponsoring, with a vote expected. The UAE also called on the U.S. to occupy Iranian-held islands in the strait, including Abu Musa, which Iran has held for 50 years but the UAE claims.[1]
- **US (NATO):** Trump told Britain's Daily Telegraph he is "beyond reconsideration" on pulling the U.S. out of NATO, calling the alliance a "paper tiger" after European members refused to join the war on Iran. He added that Russian President Putin shares his dim view of NATO's credibility.[1]

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security.

The Rich Report

The Good News:

- **AI Cracks Math:** An AI has solved a genuine open research problem from FrontierMath's hardest benchmark — a conjecture posed by mathematicians Will Brian and Paul Larson in 2019 that neither they nor others could resolve in multiple attempts. This marks a milestone where AI moves beyond textbook mathematics into original, unsolved territory that has stumped human experts.[2]
- **Lyme Vaccine Progress:** Pfizer and Valneva report their experimental Lyme disease vaccine reduced tick-borne infections by over 70% across four doses. Despite missing a statistical threshold, the companies plan to submit data to regulators. If approved, it would be the only Lyme vaccine currently available to people — a significant step given Lyme disease affects roughly 476,000 Americans annually.[2]
- **Smarter Data Centers:** The industry is shifting from AC to DC power distribution in data centers, eliminating wasteful conversion steps that multiply as AI rack power demands approach 1 megawatt. Switching to 800-V DC cuts copper requirements by 45%, improves efficiency by 5%, and reduces total ownership costs by 30% at gigawatt scale — with commercial products from Vertiv, Eaton, and Delta arriving in 2026.[2]
- **Healthcare Costs Slowing:** US healthcare spending growth has permanently decelerated, reaching 18% of GDP in 2024 — far below the 21.2% projected by government actuaries in 2010, representing nearly $1 trillion in avoided costs. Researchers attribute the slowdown partly to technological advances making treatments cheaper and more effective.[2]

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security.

The Rich Report

Dividend Portfolio News:

- **GD:** General Dynamics secured a $1.27B contract modification for submarine work, reinforcing its naval defense franchise. Defense sentiment broadly improved as Trump proposed a record $1.5T defense budget prioritizing missile defense and ships — directly aligned with GD's combat systems and marine segments.[4]
- **LMT:** Lockheed Martin had a busy week: it won a $1.36B missile contract modification, opened a rapid prototyping facility, and the Pentagon announced plans to triple Patriot missile seeker output. Separately, the Artemis II crewed lunar mission — built on Lockheed's Orion capsule — successfully launched and completed its historic lunar flyby. Trump's proposed $1.5T defense budget adds further tailwind.[4]
- **NEE:** NextEra Energy was among the top utility gainers in Q1, alongside ETR and EIX. Nvidia's growing $18B+ public equity investment portfolio, which includes clean energy exposure, reflects continued institutional confidence in the sector NEE leads.[4]
- **ORI:** Old Republic launched a new subsidiary to underwrite specialized property insurance products, expanding beyond its core commercial lines and title insurance businesses into a higher-growth niche segment.[4]

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security.

The Rich Report

Growth Portfolio News

- **CVX:** Chevron resumed Leviathan gas production offshore Israel after disruption. The company confirmed an exclusive power supply deal with Microsoft and Engine No. 1, with a $7B Texas plant reportedly involved. Chevron made a final investment decision on Equatorial Guinea's Aseng gas project. Oil surging to $110/bbl on Iran war escalation fears benefits CVX, though a proposed EU windfall tax on energy firms poses a downside risk.[4]
- **HOOD:** Robinhood was selected alongside BNY Mellon to help administer Trump Accounts, federally proposed savings accounts for children — a significant business development expanding its institutional footprint. Elon Musk denied reports that Robinhood was excluded from the SpaceX IPO. A U.S. regulator sued three states over prediction market regulation, indirectly relevant to Robinhood's expanding derivatives offerings.[4]
- **NVDA:** Nvidia's CoWoS advanced packaging supply remains secured, but Rubin (next-gen architecture) faces delay concerns per KeyBanc. H100 GPU rental prices surged ~40% in six months per SemiAnalysis, reflecting tight supply. Iran threats against Nvidia and other tech majors introduced geopolitical risk. The Vera Rubin design shift from 4-die to 2-die likely pressured memory suppliers. Nvidia's $2B investment in Marvell, focused on NVLink Fusion, signals deepening custom silicon ecosystem strategy.[4]
- **TSM:** TSMC is targeting 2028 for 3nm chip production in Japan, expanding its geographic manufacturing footprint. Insider trading activity at TSMC was noted as significant. Intel is reportedly in talks with Amazon and Google for packaging services, which could affect TSMC's packaging business competitively.[4]

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security.

The Rich Report

Summary:

In regard to the United States Economy, global bond yields rose sharply as the Iran conflict reignited inflation fears through energy price shocks. Manufacturing expanded for a third consecutive month, though input costs surged dramatically. The trade deficit narrowed as exports climbed and imports fell, with China displaced as a top supplier by Taiwan's AI-driven semiconductor surge. The S&P 500 gained over three percent, led by communications services amid SpaceX IPO optimism.

In the world of digital assets, Bitcoin fell nearly 24% in Q1 2026, its worst quarterly decline in eight years, while the Fear & Greed Index sat in extreme fear territory for 46 consecutive days — a streak unseen since the Terra-Luna collapse. Institutional investors who entered at cycle highs are reassessing positions. The SEC scheduled an April roundtable on the CLARITY Act, signaling progress toward resolving long-standing regulatory ambiguity between the SEC and CFTC over digital assets jurisdiction.

Recently around the globe, the Iran conflict continues reshaping energy markets and geopolitics. Asia is absorbing the sharpest oil supply disruptions, while France and Japan coordinate diplomatically on reopening the Strait of Hormuz. Iran's parliament approved a toll system for strait transits payable in yuan or crypto. Israel's offensive in Lebanon has displaced over a million people, and Trump signaled potential U.S. disengagement, preferring allies handle the strait militarily.

For the good news, artificial intelligence reached a milestone by solving an open mathematical conjecture that had stumped human experts for years, moving beyond textbook problems into genuine research territory. Pfizer and Valneva reported their Lyme disease vaccine reduced infections by over 70%, potentially the first approved for public use. The data center industry is shifting to DC power distribution, cutting copper use by 45% and reducing total ownership costs by 30% at scale.

In the news for the dividend portfolio, defense holdings had a strong week as Trump proposed a record budget prioritizing missile systems and naval platforms, directly benefiting General Dynamics and Lockheed Martin, both of which secured major contract wins. Lockheed's Orion capsule completed a successful lunar flyby on the Artemis II mission. NextEra Energy continued demonstrating institutional support, and Old Republic expanded into specialized property insurance through a newly launched subsidiary.

And, for the growth portfolio, Chevron benefited from oil near $111 per barrel while securing new energy agreements. Robinhood was selected to help administer federally proposed children's savings accounts, expanding its institutional profile. Nvidia saw H100 rental prices surge roughly 40% over six months amid persistent supply tightness, though architecture delays and geopolitical risks add uncertainty. TSMC announced plans for 3nm chip production in Japan by 2028, broadening its global manufacturing footprint.

Paradiem IOWN

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security.

The Rich Report

Resources:

1. Research accumulated from https://www.patreon.com/cw/PeterZeihan, https://x.com/, and https://seekingalpha.com/
2. https://newsletter.humanprogress.org/
3. Research accumulated from https://www.ftportfolios.com/ and https://bravosresearch.com/research/
4. https://seekingalpha.com/
5. https://www.coindesk.com/latest-crypto-news

Important Information:

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. All information has been obtained from sources believed to be reliable, but its accuracy is not guaranteed. There is no representation or warranty as to the current accuracy, reliability or completeness of, nor liability for, decisions based on such information and it should not be relied on as such. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security. It does not take into account any investor's particular investment objectives, strategies, tax status or investment horizon. You should consult your attorney or tax advisor.

Paradiem, LLC dba Intentional Ownership ("IOWN") is a registered investment advisor. Advisory services are only offered to clients or prospective clients where Paradiem/IOWN and its representatives are properly licensed or exempt from licensure. The information provided is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice and it should not be relied on as such. It should not be considered a solicitation to buy or an offer to sell a security.